

Word family: **represent / represents / represented / representing / representation / representative / representational / misrepresent / misrepresentation**

Base word: represent

Third-person singular: represents

Past tense: represented

Past participle: represented

-ing form: representing

Related forms: representation, representative, representational, misrepresent, misrepresentation

Useful constructions/extensions: represent a team/company/country, represent someone in court, represent an idea/value, represent something visually, represent a percentage/share, be represented by, representative of, sales representative, legal representative, representation, misrepresent

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your passage contains:

> “My supervisor asked me to **represent the team** and present a project I had spent months working on.”

Here, **represent** means:

to act, speak, or appear officially on behalf of a group.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **represent the team**

you were not simply describing the team.

You were acting as the team's **official or practical representative** at the company event.

You were there to:

* speak on behalf of the team;

* present work associated with the team;

* stand before colleagues and senior managers as the person representing that group.

Meaning: To act or speak on behalf of a person, group, organization, or country.

繁體中文: **代表某個人、團隊、機構或群體出席、發言或行事**

中文翻譯:

> “My supervisor asked me to represent the team and present a project I had spent months working on.”

「我的上司叫我**代表團隊**，介紹一個我已經做了好幾個月的項目。」

So:

****represent the team = 代表團隊出席並以團隊名義發言／介紹工作****

1. ****represent + team/company/group (團隊／公司／群體) — 代表; 代表.....出席／發言****

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To act, speak, compete, or appear officially on behalf of a group or organization.

Practice 1 — Original

> “My supervisor asked me to ****represent the team****.”

「我的上司叫我****代表團隊****。」

Practice 2

> “She was chosen to ****represent the company**** at the conference.”

「她獲選****代表公司****出席會議。」

Practice 3

> “Two employees will ****represent the department**** at the meeting.”

「兩名員工會****代表部門****出席會議。」

****represent a team/company/group = 以某個團體的名義出席、發言、行動或參與活動****

2. ****represent + country/region (國家／地區) — 代表國家／地區參賽或出席****

A very common extension.

Practice 4

> “She **represented Hong Kong** in the competition.”

「她**代表香港**參加比賽。」

Practice 5

> “The athlete has **represented his country** several times.”

「這名運動員曾多次**代表自己的國家**參賽。」

represent a country/region = 以某國家／地區的名義參加比賽、會議或國際活動

3. **represent + person** (代表某人行事) — 代表某人; 代為行事

Practice 6

> “The agent **represents** several professional athletes.”

「這名經理人**代表**幾名職業運動員處理事務。」

Practice 7

> “She asked a colleague to **represent her** at the meeting.”

「她請一位同事在會議上**代表她**出席／發言。」

represent someone = 代替某人出席、發言、談判或處理事務

4. **represent someone legally** (法律代表) — 代表某人處理法律事務

A major professional/legal sense.

Practice 8

> “The lawyer **represented** the client in court.”

「律師在法庭上**代表該客戶**。」

Practice 9

> “She was ****represented by**** an experienced attorney.”

「她由一位經驗豐富的律師****代表處理法律事務****。」

****represent someone in court = 以律師／法律代理人的身份代表某人處理法律程序****

5. ****represent = speak for a group's interests (代表利益／立場) — 代表; 維護****

This emphasizes interests rather than merely attendance.

Practice 10

> “The committee ****represents the interests of employees****.”

「委員會****代表員工利益****。」

Practice 11

> “The association ****represents small businesses****.”

「該協會****代表小型企業的利益和立場****。」

****represent someone's interests = 代表並維護某群體的利益、意見或需要****

6. ****represent = symbolize / stand for (象徵) — 象徵; 代表****

A genuinely different meaning.

****Meaning:**** To stand for or symbolize an idea, quality, value, or concept.

Practice 12

> “The colour white can ****represent peace****.”

「白色可以****象徵和平****。」

Practice 13

> “The trophy ****represents years of hard work****.”

「這座獎盃**象徵多年努力的成果**。」

represent an idea/value = 以某種人物、物件、符號或形象象徵某個抽象概念

7. **symbol/letter/number represents something (符號／字母／數字) — 代表; 表示**

Common in mathematics, science, and diagrams.

Practice 14

> “In this equation, **x** represents the unknown value.”

「在這條方程式中，**x** 代表未知數值。」

Practice 15

> “The red line **represents total sales**.”

「紅線**代表總銷售額**。」

A represents B = A 是用來表示、代替或對應 B 的符號／標記

8. **represent something visually (視覺描繪) — 描繪; 呈現**

A common art/design/media sense.

Practice 16

> “The painting **represents a busy city street**.”

「這幅畫**描繪了一條繁忙的城市街道**。」

Practice 17

> “The diagram **represents the structure of the system**.”

「這張圖**呈現了系統的結構**。」

represent something visually = 以圖像、圖表、藝術作品或模型描繪／呈現某個對象

9. **represent + person/event in art/media (描寫／刻畫) — 描寫; 刻畫**

Practice 18

> “The film **represents the character as** deeply conflicted.”

「電影把這個角色**刻畫成內心充滿矛盾的人**。」

Practice 19

> “The novel **represents rural life** in great detail.”

「小說非常細緻地**描寫鄉村生活**。」

represent = 透過文字、影像或藝術方式呈現某人／某事的形象或特徵

10. **represent A as B (把 A 描述／呈現成 B) — 把.....描寫／說成.....**

An important grammatical pattern.

Practice 20

> “The advertisement **represents the product as** simple and reliable.”

「廣告把產品**呈現成簡單而可靠**。」

Practice 21

> “The report **represented the situation as** more serious than it was.”

「報告把情況**描述得比實際更嚴重**。」

represent A as B = 把 A 描述、刻畫或呈現成 B 的樣子／身份／狀態

This can be neutral or misleading depending on accuracy.

11. **represent = constitute / be equivalent to (構成; 相當於) — 構成; 相當於**

A strong abstract sense.

Practice 22

> “This decision **represents a major change** in policy.”

「這項決定**代表／構成**政策上的重大改變。」

Practice 23

> “The promotion **represents an important step** in her career.”

「這次晉升**代表**她職業生涯中的重要一步。」

represent = 某件事本身構成、體現或相當於某個重要變化／發展

12. **represent = account for a proportion/share (佔) — 佔; 構成**

Very common in business, statistics, and reports.

Practice 24

> “Online sales **represent 40% of total revenue**.”

「網上銷售**佔**總收入的四成。」

Practice 25

> “International customers **represent a large share of the market**.”

「國際客戶**佔**市場很大一部分。」

represent + percentage/share = 在整體中佔某個比例或部分

This is a major business/academic meaning.

13. **represent = be typical of a category (具有代表性) — 代表; 典型反映**

Practice 26

> “These results **represent a typical pattern**.”

「這些結果**代表／反映了一種典型模式**。」

Practice 27

> “The sample does not fully **represent the population**.”

「這個樣本不能完全**代表整體人口的特徵**。」

represent a population/group = 能夠典型、準確地反映某個整體群體的特徵

Especially common in research and statistics.

14. **representative sample (代表性樣本) — 具代表性的樣本**

A highly useful derivative.

Practice 28

> “The survey used a **representative sample** of employees.”

「這項調查採用了員工的**具代表性樣本**。」

Practice 29

> “The sample may not be **representative of** the whole population.”

「這個樣本可能**不能代表整體人口**。」

representative of = 能夠典型、合理反映某個較大群體的特徵

15. **representative = person who represents others (代表) — 代表; 代理人**

A major related noun.

Practice 30

> “Each department sent a **representative** to the meeting.”

「每個部門都派出一名**代表**出席會議。」

Practice 31

> “She attended as the team’s **representative**.”

「她以團隊**代表**身份出席。」

representative = 被授權代表某人、團體或機構出席、發言或行事的人

16. **sales representative (銷售代表) — 銷售代表**

A common job title.

Practice 32

> “He works as a **sales representative**.”

「他任職**銷售代表**。」

Practice 33

> “A **sales representative** contacted the client.”

「一名**銷售代表**聯絡了客戶。」

sales representative = 代表公司向客戶介紹、推廣和銷售產品／服務的人員

17. **customer/service representative (客戶服務代表) — 客戶服務人員**

Practice 34

> “A customer service **representative** will contact you.”

「一名**客戶服務代表／客服人員**會聯絡你。」

Practice 35

> “I spoke to a support **representative**.”

「我跟一名**支援服務人員**交談。」

representative = 代表機構與客戶溝通及處理事務的職員

18. **legal representative (法律代表) — 法律代表; 法定代理人**

Practice 36

> “Please contact your **legal representative**.”

「請聯絡你的**法律代表／法律代理人**。」

Practice 37

> “Her **legal representative** attended the hearing.”

「她的**法律代表**出席了聆訊。」

legal representative = 獲授權在法律事務上代表另一人／機構的人

19. **representative = typical / characteristic (有代表性的) — 典型的; 有代表性的**

Now **representative** is an adjective.

Practice 38

> “This case is **representative of** a wider problem.”

「這個案例**代表／典型反映了一個更廣泛的問題**。」

Practice 39

> “The examples are **representative of** everyday usage.”

「這些例子**具代表性, 能反映日常用法**。」

representative of something = 典型地反映某個群體、類型、時期或現象的特徵

20. **representation = act of representing someone (代表行為／代理) — 代表; 代理**

Practice 40

> “Employees asked for better **representation** in management discussions.”

「員工要求在管理層討論中得到更充分的**代表／參與代表權**。」

Practice 41

> “The client received legal **representation**.”

「該客戶獲得了法律**代理／法律代表服務**。」

****representation = 由某人代表另一個人／群體發言、行事或維護利益的安排／行為****

21. **representation = depiction / portrayal (描繪／呈現) — 描繪; 表現方式**

A separate noun sense.

Practice 42

> “The film's **representation of** office life felt realistic.”

「電影對辦公室生活的**描寫／呈現**很真實。」

Practice 43

> “The chart is a visual **representation** of the data.”

「這張圖表是數據的視覺**呈現／表示方式**。」

****representation = 某人／某事透過文字、圖像、符號、藝術等被描繪或呈現的方式****

22. **representation = symbol/model standing for something (表徵／模型) — 表示; 表徵**

Common in science, mathematics, computing, and linguistics.

Practice 44

> “The diagram is a simplified **representation** of the system.”

「這張圖是系統的簡化**表示／模型**。」

Practice 45

> “The software stores a digital **representation** of the image.”

「軟件儲存圖像的數碼**表示形式**。」

representation = 用符號、數據、模型或圖像來表示另一個事物的形式

23. **representation** = proportion/presence of groups (群體代表程度) — 代表比例; 參與程度

A common workplace/social meaning.

Practice 46

> “The company wants to improve women’s **representation** in senior management.”

「公司希望提高女性在高層管理中的**代表比例／參與比例**。」

Practice 47

> “The committee has strong regional **representation**.”

「委員會中不同地區都有充分的**代表**。」

representation = 某個群體在組織、機構或決策架構中實際出現和參與的程度

24. **representational** = depicting recognizable things (具象／再現性的) — 描繪現實形象的

A useful art-related derivative.

Practice 48

> “The artist moved from **representational art** to abstraction.”

「這位藝術家由**具象／再現藝術**轉向抽象藝術。」

Practice 49

> “The painting is highly **representational**.”

「這幅畫非常**具象**，能辨認出所描繪的真實對象。」

representational art = 以可辨認的方式描繪現實人物、物件或場景的藝術

25. **misrepresent** = describe falsely/inaccurately (歪曲; 錯誤描述) — 歪曲; 失實陳述

A major useful family extension.

Practice 50

> “The report **misrepresented** what she had said.”

「報告**歪曲**了她原本的說法。」

Practice 51

> “Do not **misrepresent** the results.”

「不要**失實呈現／歪曲**研究結果。」

misrepresent = 以不準確、失實或誤導的方式描述／呈現某人或某事

26. **misrepresent yourself** (虛假描述自己的身份／資格) — 冒充; 失實陳述自己

Practice 52

> “He was accused of **misrepresenting himself** as a qualified lawyer.”

「他被指控**虛假聲稱**自己是合資格律師。」

Practice 53

> “Applicants must not **misrepresent their experience**.”

「申請人不得**失實陳述**自己的經驗。」

****misrepresent yourself/your qualifications = 對自己的身份、背景、能力或資格作出虛假／誤導描述****

27. ****misrepresentation (失實陳述) — 歪曲; 不實陳述****

Practice 54

> “The advertisement was criticized for ****misrepresentation****.”

「這則廣告因****失實陳述／誤導性描述****而受到批評。」

Practice 55

> “The contract may be challenged if there was serious ****misrepresentation****.”

「如果存在嚴重****失實陳述****，合約可能會受到質疑。」

****misrepresentation = 對事實、情況、身份或產品作出不準確／誤導性描述的行為****

This is especially common in legal/business contexts.

28. ****be represented by + person (由……代表) — 由……代表****

Practice 56

> “The team was ****represented by**** two employees.”

「團隊由兩名員工****代表****。」

Practice 57

> “The company was ****represented by**** its legal adviser.”

「公司由其法律顧問****代表****。」

****be represented by someone = 某人／機構由指定人物代為出席、發言或行事****

29. ****be represented by + symbol/color (由……表示) — 以……表示****

Practice 58

> “Sales are **represented by** the blue line.”

「銷售額**以藍線表示**。」

Practice 59

> “Each department is **represented by** a different colour.”

「每個部門都**以不同顏色表示**。」

be represented by = 某項資料／概念以特定符號、顏色、圖形等作為表示方式

Same grammar, different lexical concept from person-representation.

30. **represent a threat/problem/opportunity** (構成) — 構成; 意味著

A common formal use.

Practice 60

> “The delay **represents a serious problem**.”

「這次延誤**構成一個嚴重問題**。」

Practice 61

> “The new market **represents a major opportunity**.”

「這個新市場**代表／帶來一個重大機會**。」

represent + abstract situation = 某件事本身構成、意味著或形成某種問題、機會、風險等

31. **represent a change/development/step** (代表某種變化／發展) — 標誌; 代表

Practice 62

> “The new role **represents a major step forward** in her career.”

「這個新職位**標誌著她事業上的重大進步**。」

Practice 63

> “The policy **represents a significant change** in approach.”

「這項政策**代表／標誌著處理方式上的重大改變**。」

represent = 某項行動／決定本身反映或標誌著某種重要發展

Important distinction: **represent vs present**

This is especially important because both appear in your sentence.

represent the team

= act on behalf of the team

「代表團隊」

present the project

= formally explain/show the project

「介紹／匯報項目」

Your sentence therefore contains two different jobs:

> “represent the team and present a project”

= **代表團隊 + 匯報項目**

Do not confuse the two verbs.

Important distinction: **represent vs speak for**

These overlap.

represent someone

is broader:

- * attend on their behalf;
- * negotiate;
- * act officially;
- * defend their interests;
- * speak for them.

speak for someone

focuses specifically on expressing their views or position.

So:

> “I represented the team.”

may include more than speaking.

> “I spoke for the team.”

focuses on what I said on the team’s behalf.

Important distinction: **represent vs symbolize**

represent

is broader.

It can mean:

- * act on behalf of;
- * symbolize;
- * depict;
- * stand for;
- * constitute.

symbolize

specifically means:

> stand as a symbol of an idea/value.

Compare:

> “She represents the company.”

= 她代表公司。

> “The dove symbolizes peace.”

= 白鴿象徵和平。

You could also say:

> “The dove represents peace.”

So **represent** can overlap with **symbolize**, but it is much broader.

Important distinction: **represent** vs **depict**

represent

can mean visually portray something, but also has many abstract meanings.

depict

specifically emphasizes visual/written portrayal.

> “The painting depicts a street scene.”

= 畫作描繪街景。

> “The painting represents city life.”

can mean:

* depicts it;

* symbolizes it.

So **represent** may be more interpretive.

Important distinction: **represent vs describe**

describe

focuses on giving details in words.

represent

focuses on presenting, portraying, standing for, or depicting.

> “She described the problem.”

= 她描述了問題。

> “The diagram represents the problem.”

= 圖表表示／呈現這個問題。

Important distinction: **represent = act for vs represent = stand for**

This is the central polysemy split.

Act for:

> “She **represents the company**.”

= 她**代表公司行事／發言**。

Stand for:

> “The symbol **represents peace**.”

= 這個符號**代表／象徵和平**。

Same verb, different mental concept.

Important distinction: **represent = depict vs represent = constitute**

Depict:

> “The picture represents a city.”

= 圖像描繪一座城市。

Constitute:

> “This represents a major change.”

= 這**構成／代表一次重大改變**。

The second does not involve pictures or symbols.

Important distinction: **representative = person vs representative = typical**

Noun:

> “She is our **representative**.”

= 她是我們的**代表**。

Adjective:

> “This sample is **representative** of the population.”

= 這個樣本**具有代表性**。

Same form, different grammatical function.

Important distinction: **representative vs representative sample**

A **representative** person may simply be:

> someone acting on behalf of others.

A **representative sample** means:

> a sample whose characteristics reasonably reflect the whole population.

So:

****representative — noun = 代表****

****representative — adjective = 具有代表性的****

Important distinction: **representation = representation by people vs representation as portrayal**

People/voice:

> “Employees need better representation.”

= 員工需要更充分的代表權／代表參與。

Portrayal:

> “The film's representation of office life...”

= 電影對辦公室生活的描寫。

Completely different concepts under the same noun.

Important distinction: **representation vs presentation**

These are commonly confused.

**representation**

= 代表、描繪、表示

**presentation**

= 簡報、呈現、展示

Compare:

> “She gave a ****presentation****.”

= 她作簡報。

> “She acted as our ****representative****.”

= 她擔任我們的代表。

> “The chart is a **representation** of the data.”

= 圖表是數據的表示形式。

Important distinction: **represent** vs **account for**

In statistics/business:

> “Online sales **represent** 40% of revenue.”

and:

> “Online sales **account for** 40% of revenue.”

can mean essentially:

網上銷售佔總收入四成

Represent sounds slightly more like:

> constitute that proportion

while **account for** is a very common percentage-expression.

Important distinction: **represent** vs **reflect**

represent

can mean:

> stand for / constitute / typify.

reflect

often means:

> show or reveal the characteristics/result of something.

Compare:

> “This sample represents the population.”

= 樣本具有代表性。

> “The results reflect customer concerns.”

= 結果反映顧客關注。

They overlap, but not perfectly.

Important distinction: **misrepresent vs misunderstand**

misrepresent

= describe/present something inaccurately, often to others

misunderstand

= personally understand something incorrectly

> “He misunderstood my point.”

= 他誤解我的意思。

> “He misrepresented my point.”

= 他向別人歪曲／錯誤陳述我的意思。

Very different.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **represent** family is rich across agency, symbolism, depiction, statistics, and related nouns:

* **represent a team/company/group** = 代表團隊／公司／群體

* **represent a country** = 代表國家參賽／出席

* **represent a person** = 代表某人行事

* **represent someone legally** = 法律上代表某人

- * **represent someone's interests** = 代表／維護某群體利益
- * **represent an idea/value** = 象徵／代表某概念
- * **symbol represents something** = 符號表示某事物
- * **represent visually** = 描繪／呈現
- * **represent A as B** = 把 A 描寫／呈現成 B
- * **represent = constitute** = 構成／相當於
- * **represent + percentage** = 佔某比例
- * **represent a population** = 具有代表性地反映整體
- * **representative — person** = 代表／代理人
- * **representative — adjective** = 具代表性的
- * **sales representative** = 銷售代表
- * **legal representative** = 法律代表
- * **representation — agency** = 代表／代理
- * **representation — portrayal** = 描寫／呈現
- * **representation — symbolic/data form** = 表示／表徵
- * **representation — group presence** = 群體代表比例／參與程度
- * **representational** = 具象／再現性的
- * **misrepresent** = 歪曲／失實描述
- * **misrepresentation** = 失實陳述／歪曲
- * **be represented by + person** = 由某人代表
- * **be represented by + symbol** = 以某符號表示
- * **represent a threat/problem/opportunity** = 構成問題／威脅／機會
- * **represent a change/step** = 標誌／代表某種重要發展

The main semantic branches are:

- > **act on behalf of**
- > **stand for / symbolize**
- > **depict / portray**
- > **constitute / amount to**
- > **typify / reflect a larger group**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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represent a team/company/group	以某個團體或機構的名義出席、發言、行動或參與活動
represent a country/region	以某個國家或地區的名義參加比賽、會議或國際活動

represent a person	代替某人出席、發言、談判或處理事務	
represent someone legally	以律師／法律代理身份代表某人處理法律程序	
represent someone's interests	代表並維護某群體的利益、意見或需要	
represent an idea/value	以某種人物、物件、符號或形象象徵某個抽象概念	
symbol/letter represents something	用某個符號、字母、數字等表示或對應另一個事物	
represent visually	以圖像、圖表、藝術作品或模型描繪／呈現某個對象	
represent A as B	把 A 描述、刻畫或呈現成 B 的樣子、身份或狀態	
represent = constitute	某件事本身構成、體現或相當於某種變化、發展或情況	
represent + percentage/share	在整體中佔某個比例或部分	
represent a population/group	能夠典型而準確地反映較大群體的特徵	
representative — person	被授權代表某人、團體或機構出席、發言或行事的人	
representative — adjective	能夠典型、合理反映某個群體、類型或現象特徵的	
sales representative	代表公司向客戶介紹、推廣及銷售產品／服務的人員	
legal representative	獲授權在法律事務上代表另一人／機構的人	
representation — acting for others	由某人代表另一人／群體發言、行事或維護利益的安排／行為	
representation — portrayal	某人／某事透過文字、圖像、符號、藝術等被描繪或呈現的方式	
representation — symbolic/data form	用符號、數據、模型或圖像表示另一事物的形式	
representation — group presence	某個群體在組織／機構／決策架構中的代表比例及參與程度	
representational	以可辨認方式描繪現實人物、物件或場景的；具象／再現性的	
misrepresent	以不準確、失實或誤導方式描述／呈現某人或某事	
misrepresentation	對事實、身份、情況或產品作出不準確／誤導描述的行為	
be represented by + person	由指定人物代為出席、發言或行事	
be represented by + symbol	以特定符號、顏色、圖形等作為表示方式	
represent a problem/threat/opportunity	某件事本身構成或形成某種問題、威脅、風險或機會	
represent a change/step	某項行動或決定反映、標誌或構成某種重要發展	

For your original passage

> “My supervisor asked me to ****represent the team**** and present a project I had spent months working on.”

The exact meaning is:

****represent = 以團隊的名義出席公司活動，並在其他同事和高層面前代替團隊發言／介紹工作****

Therefore:

> ****represent the team****

= ****「代表團隊出席並以團隊名義發言／行事」****

The key point is that you were not merely speaking as an individual.

You were acting as:

> **the person standing for the team at that event**

That helps explain why the situation felt more serious: what you said and how you performed could be seen as reflecting not just you personally, but the team you were there to represent.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **represent the team**

> = 代表團隊行事／發言

> **represent the company in court**

> = 在法律上代表公司

> **a symbol represents an idea**

> = 符號代表／象徵概念

> **a painting represents a scene**

> = 畫作描繪場景

> **sales represent 40% of revenue**

> = 銷售額佔收入四成

> **a representative sample**

> = 具代表性的樣本

> **a representative**

> = 代表／代理人

> **representation**

> = 可指代表、描繪、表示形式或群體代表程度

> **misrepresent**

> = 歪曲／失實呈現

So in your passage specifically, the core mapping is:

represent the team = 代表團隊，以團隊名義出席、發言和介紹工作。